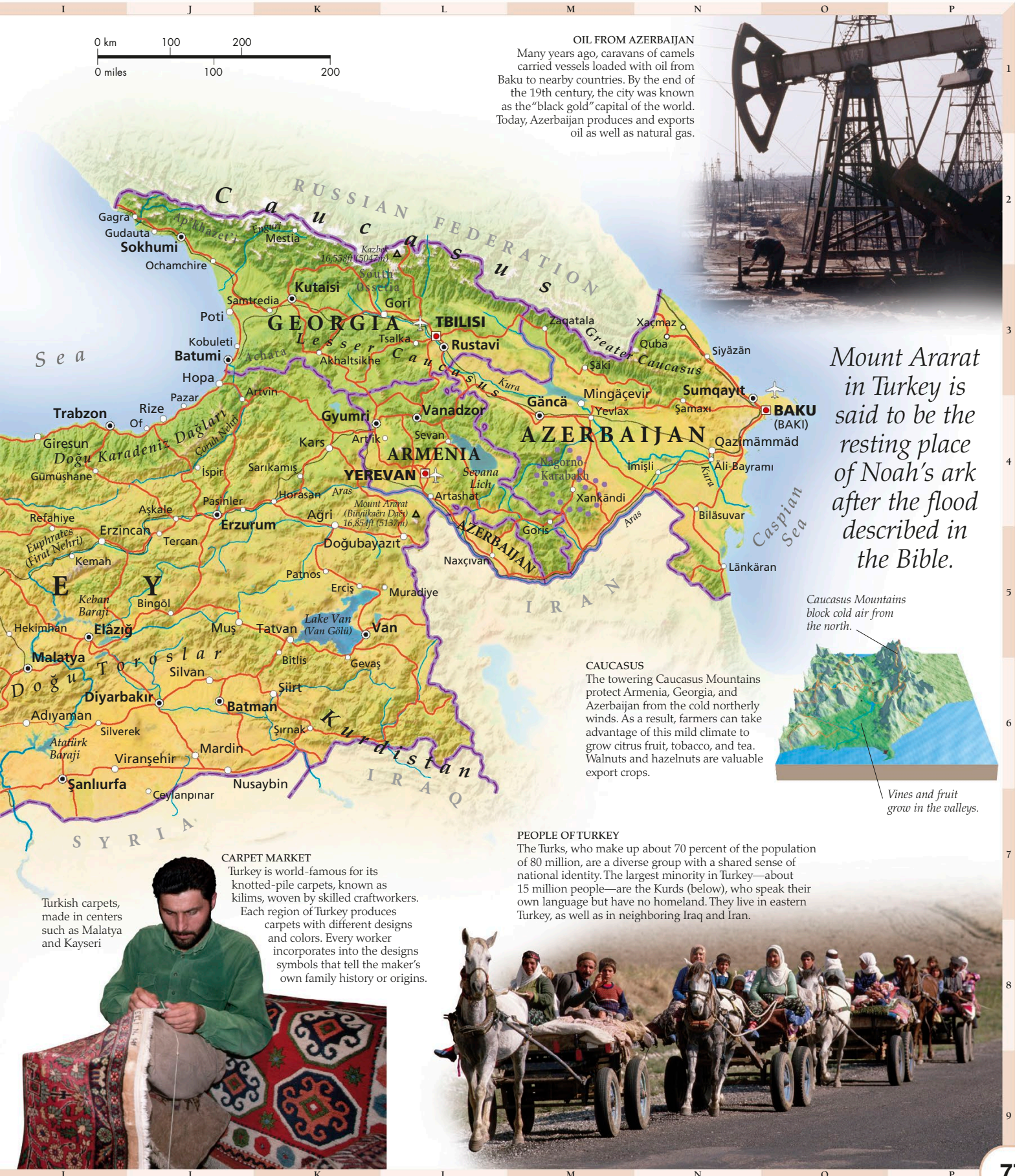
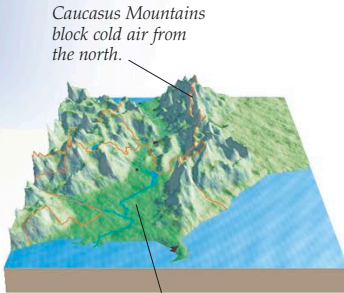




OIL FROM AZERBAIJAN
Many years ago, caravans of camels carried vessels loaded with oil from Baku to nearby countries. By the end of the 19th century, the city was known as the "black gold" capital of the world. Today, Azerbaijan produces and exports oil as well as natural gas.

Mount Ararat in Turkey is said to be the resting place of Noah's ark after the flood described in the Bible.

CAUCASUS
The towering Caucasus Mountains protect Armenia, Georgia, and Azerbaijan from the cold northerly winds. As a result, farmers can take advantage of this mild climate to grow citrus fruit, tobacco, and tea. Walnuts and hazelnuts are valuable export crops.



Vines and fruit grow in the valleys.

CARPET MARKET
Turkey is world-famous for its knotted-pile carpets, known as kilims, woven by skilled craftworkers. Each region of Turkey produces carpets with different designs and colors. Every worker incorporates into the designs symbols that tell the maker's own family history or origins.

PEOPLE OF TURKEY
The Turks, who make up about 70 percent of the population of 80 million, are a diverse group with a shared sense of national identity. The largest minority in Turkey—about 15 million people—are the Kurds (below), who speak their own language but have no homeland. They live in eastern Turkey, as well as in neighboring Iraq and Iran.

Turkish carpets, made in centers such as Malatya and Kayseri